Build only what the question requires

A prototype plan for decisions, realism and the limits of a test.

01	Name the decision before choosing fidelity.	02	Choose the prototype by what could go wrong.
03	Plan the necessary realism.	04	Write the task without explaining the interface.
05	Agree what would change the choice.	06	State what the test cannot establish.

Name the decision before choosing fidelity.

Hypothetical question: can a person compare plan limits before selecting a subscription?

NEEDED REALISM

Plan names, limits and comparison behaviour

These details determine what the person can understand and do.

UNNECESSARY POLISH

Final illustration and account settings

Leave these rough when they cannot change the answer to this question.

Choose the prototype by what could go wrong.

A static view can answer some questions. An interaction question needs enough behaviour to expose the difficult moment.

Question	Prototype requirement
Can they find the limit?	Accurate content and hierarchy.
Can they compare two options?	The comparison states and navigation must work.
Do they understand the confirmation?	A realistic action and result.
What happens after an error?	The error and recovery behaviour.

Plan the necessary realism.

Keep the parts that can affect the answer accurate. Record rough areas so observers do not overinterpret them.

Must behave accurately

Which interaction or content can change the observation?

Can remain rough

Which detail is outside this question?

Known prototype limit

What difficulty could come from the prototype itself?

Write the task without explaining the interface.

Example task: choose a plan that supports the export you need. Do not tell the person which table or button contains the answer.

Task to give the person

Describe the goal, not the interface instructions.

Observation to record

What choice, hesitation or misunderstanding matters?

Help to withhold

Which explanation would hide the difficulty we need to inspect?

Agree what would change the choice.

Make the evidence condition clear before watching the session.

Decision under review

Which option is the team considering?

Reason to revise

Which observation would make us reject that option?

Decision owner and next step

Who will use the finding, and for which commitment?

State what the test cannot establish.

A person completing this task can inform the comparison design. It cannot prove what they would buy or how revenue would change.

Supported conclusion

Which decision can this observation inform?

Remaining uncertainty

Which question needs a different method or setting?

Next commitment

What are we willing to change based on this evidence?